

Big circle : The sailor's wife

Comp. : Trad. Scotland

Disc. : Ian Fraser

Notes : "Big circle" is the original name given by the choreographers to the mixer dance 99% of Balfolkers wrongly name as "Circassian circle" which is in fact a dance from the British isles. To confuse matters even further, the Circassians are a Caucasian ethnic group! Oy! This is a pre-18th century tune with a baroque-like melody. It's great fun to play in jams or on stage. It's safe to say that the sailor's wife was a good dancer knowing full well the meaning of the Irish-gaelic word Craic!!

♩ = 120

The musical score is written in 6/8 time with a key signature of one flat (Bb). It consists of two systems of music, each with first and second endings.

System 1 (Measures 1-5):

- Measure 1: Chord **A** (boxed), Dm
- Measure 2: Chord Am
- Measure 3: Chord Dm
- Measure 4: Chord Am
- Measure 5: Chord Dm

System 2 (Measures 6-10):

- Measure 6: Chord A
- Measure 7: Chord Dm (1. ending)
- Measure 8: Chord Dm (2. ending)
- Measure 9: Chord F (boxed, B)
- Measure 10: Chord F

System 3 (Measures 11-15):

- Measure 11: Chord G
- Measure 12: Chord C
- Measure 13: Chord A
- Measure 14: Chord Dm
- Measure 15: Chord C

System 4 (Measures 16-20):

- Measure 16: Chord Dm
- Measure 17: Chord Dm (1. ending)
- Measure 18: Chord Dm (2. ending)
- Measure 19: Chord Dm
- Measure 20: Chord Dm